

Parrot Security OS: A Powerful Tool for Cybersecurity



Explore the key features of the Parrot Security OS and the range of cybersecurity tools available in it. Then take a quick look at how this OS compares with Kali Linux.

Developed by ParrotSec, Parrot Security OS is a powerful Debian-based open source operating system specifically designed for penetration testing, ethical hacking, digital forensics, and cybersecurity. Its key features are:

Lightweight: This OS is designed to be lightweight and less demanding on system resources. It utilises RAM and CPU efficiently and can run well in any system that has 2GB of RAM. Since the kernel of the OS is optimised it is suitable for older machines as well. Parrot Security uses a desktop environment called MATE, which is significantly lighter than other environments such as GNOME or KDE. The MATE platform balances aesthetics and performance well, and is user-friendly in nature.

Modular approach: Users can install just the tools they require with Parrot OS's modular installation approach, ensuring the system is not burdened with extraneous software.

Pre-installed cybersecurity tools: This OS has various suites of tools that are vital for cybersecurity and can be used for penetration testing, ethical hacking, digital forensics, privacy, cryptography, etc.

Frequent updates: Updates in Parrot OS are incremental as it follows a rolling release model. Users get the latest features of the OS immediately and avoid the hassle of full system upgrade. Security vulnerabilities get patched quickly.

Cloud-friendly and optimised for virtualisation: The OS has been optimised to minimise resource usage

in order to run effectively on cloud environments and virtual machines.

Cybersecurity tools in Parrot Security

Parrot Security OS is equipped with an extensive array of cybersecurity tools tailored for ethical hacking, penetration testing, digital forensics, and security research. It features a comprehensive selection of pre-installed tools organised into various categories addressing different facets of cybersecurity (Table 1).

The OS provides a range of tools for penetration testing, including the Metasploit Framework, which is extensively utilised for exploiting vulnerabilities. Another significant tool is Burp Suite, known for its effectiveness in web application